POWER BI Project 1: Sales Analysis

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Agenda

Growth Strong, Profit Quality Mixed

Sales are growing fast, but margins and execution need control

What the dashboard says

Sales reached 2.30M, with 286.4K profit and 46.88% YoY growth.

Discounts, weak sub-categories, and uneven execution are hurting margin quality; protect growth while improving pricing, mix, and execution.

Management implications

- → Growth momentum is clearly strong
- → Profitability remains structurally uneven
- → Execution must raise margin quality

Decision support for leaders

From dashboard evidence to commercial and operating action

01

Project objective

Turn extracted dashboard outputs into practical decisions on sales, operations, and strategic planning.

02

Business questions covered

Assess sales trends, customer behavior, product performance, profitability, regional results, discount effects, and logistics choices.

03

Management value

Provide one fact base that helps commercial and operating leaders align on priorities, test tradeoffs, and act with confidence.

Transaction-level data and method

Dataset fields and analytical logic used as the basis for insight

What the data contains

- Order date, ship date, ship mode
- Customer, segment, geography
- Category, sub-category, product

Sales, quantity, discount, and profit complete transaction-level coverage.

01

How the analysis works

- Data exploration of patterns
- Comparative analysis across segments
- Predictive and influencer logic

Dashboard text is the authoritative record for visuals and KPIs.

02

Scale is solid. Unit economics need discipline

Healthy volume and selective wins, but thin order economics make pricing and discounts critical.

1

$2.30M total sales

Revenue scale is meaningful. The business processed 9,994 rows with max sales of $22.64K. Volume is real, not isolated. Execution can compound from here.

2

$286.4K total profit

Profit pool is material. Max profit reached $8.40K, showing upside exists. But profit concentration matters. Quality of earnings still needs scrutiny.

3

$229.86 average sales

Average order value is modest. That puts pressure on mix, pricing, and fulfillment. Small changes in discounting or cost discipline can move outcomes quickly.

4

$28.66 average profit

Average profit per row is thin. Average discount was 8.57%, quantity averaged 4, and discounts reached 100%. Order economics require active control.

Growth returned, but profit quality is the test

Sales rebounded sharply after a weak 2017, creating momentum that now needs durable profit conversion.

$484.25K

2016 sales

Baseline year before the dip.

$470.53K

2017 sales

A weak year signaled execution pressure.

$609.21K

2018 sales

Recovery showed stronger demand capture.

46.88%

Latest YoY growth

2019 reached $733.22K with sharp acceleration.

Management reading of the trend

From decline to acceleration

01

Annual sales moved from $484.25K in 2016 to $470.53K in 2017, then recovered to $609.21K in 2018 and $733.22K in 2019. This is more than growth on paper. It suggests stronger demand capture and improved commercial execution after a soft period.

The leadership question now

02

The latest 46.88% YoY gain creates momentum, but leadership should test whether growth is translating into durable profit quality across categories, customers, pricing decisions, and operating execution. Scale without healthy conversion can hide risk.

Seasonality should drive operating choices

Peak demand clusters late in the year, so planning must protect margin and promotion discipline.

Revenue peaks late

Sales are strongest in September, November, and December. Demand is concentrated, not evenly spread. The calendar should shape commercial plans.

Profit is uneven

Profit varies by month and does not rise evenly with revenue. Higher sales do not automatically mean better earnings quality.

Plan peaks carefully

Year-end surges likely reward better stock readiness, tighter promotion timing, and stronger margin control. Volume alone is not the goal.

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Strategic implication

Management should prepare inventory, staffing, and promotions for seasonal surges while avoiding discount-led volume as the default path to target attainment. The goal is to capture peak demand with stronger profit quality, not just higher sales.

Balanced category sales, uneven value

Revenue is well spread across Technology, Furniture, and Office Supplies, but profit quality still varies.

01

Technology

Technology leads sales at 36.4% or about 836.15K. It anchors the mix, but value still depends on margin quality and discount control.

- 36.4% of total sales
- About 836.15K revenue
- Balance lowers risk

02

Furniture

Furniture contributes 32.3% of sales or about 742K. The category is a major revenue pillar, but margin resilience may differ from category peers.

- 32.3% of total sales
- About 742K revenue
- Value quality may vary

03

Office Supplies

Office Supplies contributes 31.3% of sales or about 719.05K. The mix looks balanced overall, but equal sales share does not mean equal profit creation.

- 31.3% of total sales
- About 719.05K revenue
- Balanced sales, mixed profit

Sub-category profit separates winners from leaks

Profit contribution shows where mix creates value and where intervention is most urgent.

01 Profit engines

Top contributors are Copiers at 56K, Phones at 45K, Accessories at 42K, Paper at 34K, and Binders at 30K. These sub-categories show where scale converts into profit and deserve focused support.

02 Urgent value leaks

The biggest drags are Tables at negative 55K, Machines at negative 18K, Bookcases at negative 15K, Fasteners at negative 10K, and Supplies at negative 6K. These areas need pricing, assortment, or service model correction.

Mix management matters more than topline volume alone

Profit pools are concentrated in a few sub-categories, while Tables and Machines destroy value despite solid demand. Management should act on mix, pricing, assortment, and service choices to reduce margin erosion.

Sales leaders are not always value leaders

High revenue does not guarantee profit, especially where pricing and portfolio discipline are weak.

Shift toward contribution

Management should look beyond sales tables and prioritize contribution quality. The top sales sub-categories are Phones at 330K, Chairs at 328K, Storage at 224K, Tables at 207K, and Binders at 203K. This mix blends strong value creators with weak performers, especially Tables, which pairs high sales with deep losses. Tighten pricing guardrails, refine assortment, and expand selectively in profit-accretive areas.

01

Why now

- Tables: high sales, big losses
- Phones and Binders drive value
- Scale can mask weak margins
- Shift portfolio to lift profit

02

What to do

Use sales leadership as a starting point, not the decision rule. Protect and expand attractive sub-categories such as Phones and Binders, while fixing or pruning Tables and Machines. Reinforce price discipline, sharpen assortment choices, and redirect commercial attention toward areas with stronger profit conversion.

Segment mix: volume vs. profit

Consumer leads sales, while Home Office shows stronger average profit

01 **Sales contribution**

Consumer contributes the most sales at about 1.161M. Corporate follows at about 706K, and Home Office at about 430K. Consumer remains the scale engine.

02 **Profitability quality**

Home Office shows the highest average profit despite lower sales. Corporate sits between the two. The mix suggests useful practices may sit in smaller, higher-quality segments.

Protect scale, replicate better economics

Leadership should protect Consumer volume while testing whether Home Office pricing, mix, or service practices can improve profitability in larger segments.

Customer concentration insights

Top accounts matter, but no single customer dominates sales

Three concentration themes

Top tier is meaningful

Sean Miller leads at 25K, followed by Tamara C at 19K. Raymond and Tom Ash are near 15K, with several others around 12K to 14K.

Risk is contained

No single customer dominates the business, so concentration risk appears manageable. That gives room to pursue growth without outsized exposure to one account.

Action should be targeted

Focus top accounts on retention, account development, and cross-sell. Small gains from proven customers may be more efficient than broad acquisition.

Management implications

Build named-account plans for the top tier. Verify profitability account by account, protect renewals, and target cross-sell where wallet share appears expandable.

Product concentration priorities

A small set of products can materially shape growth and margin

Top products drive the agenda

Top sellers include Canon image at 62K, Fellowes products at 27K, Cisco Telepresence at 23K, HON 5400 at 22K, and several GBC and HP items between 17K and 20K. That concentration can support focused growth, but only if margin quality and supply reliability hold.

What management should verify

- Check margin after discounts
- Confirm replenishment reliability
- Assess substitution and cross-sell

Regional sales favor the coasts

Territory strategy should separate market potential from execution gaps before shifting support

West leads

West delivers 725K in sales, making it the strongest region and a clear proof point for where demand is already scaling.

East close behind

East reaches 679K, confirming that coastal markets are the main commercial engines and sustain strong customer traction.

South trails

South generates 392K, well below West, East, and Central, signaling weaker penetration, softer demand, or uneven execution.

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Management should diagnose structure versus execution before reallocating effort

Regional spread suggests stronger market traction in coastal regions, with weaker performance in the South. Leaders should test whether the gap reflects market size, channel structure, coverage, pricing, or sales execution before changing sales effort or promotional support.

Profit leadership is more selective

Regional revenue scale does not convert evenly into profit across territories

01 Sales footprint

Sales are broad, with West at 725K, East at 679K, Central at 501K, and South at 392K. Revenue presence alone suggests reach, not quality of earnings.

02 Profit realization

Visible regional profit is far narrower: West posts 10.09K, East 4.60K, and Central 0.11K. Profit does not scale evenly with sales across geographies.

Review why strong sales do not translate into equal returns

Regional profit gaps suggest differences in mix, discounting, and service cost. Management should diagnose the causes, then tighten pricing, assortment, and fulfillment economics by region.

Top cities are growth anchors

Use city concentration to shape urban territory strategy before broader expansion

Focused urban growth plays

Build city-based account plans around the top revenue markets. Prioritize localized assortment, stronger service coverage, and targeted commercial investment in proven urban anchors before expanding into lower-yield territories.

01

Why these cities matter

- NYC leads at 256K sales
- LA contributes 176K
- Seattle and SF stay strong
- Philadelphia adds 109K

02

How to validate

Top cities by sales are New York City at 256K, Los Angeles at 176K, Seattle at 120K, San Francisco at 113K, and Philadelphia at 109K. This concentration suggests repeatable demand patterns, strong customer density, and better sales productivity. Reinforce local assortment and service levels in these markets first.

Shipping mode shapes profit quality

Standard Class delivers the strongest profit outcome, while faster modes require tighter use.

01 Lower-cost fulfillment wins

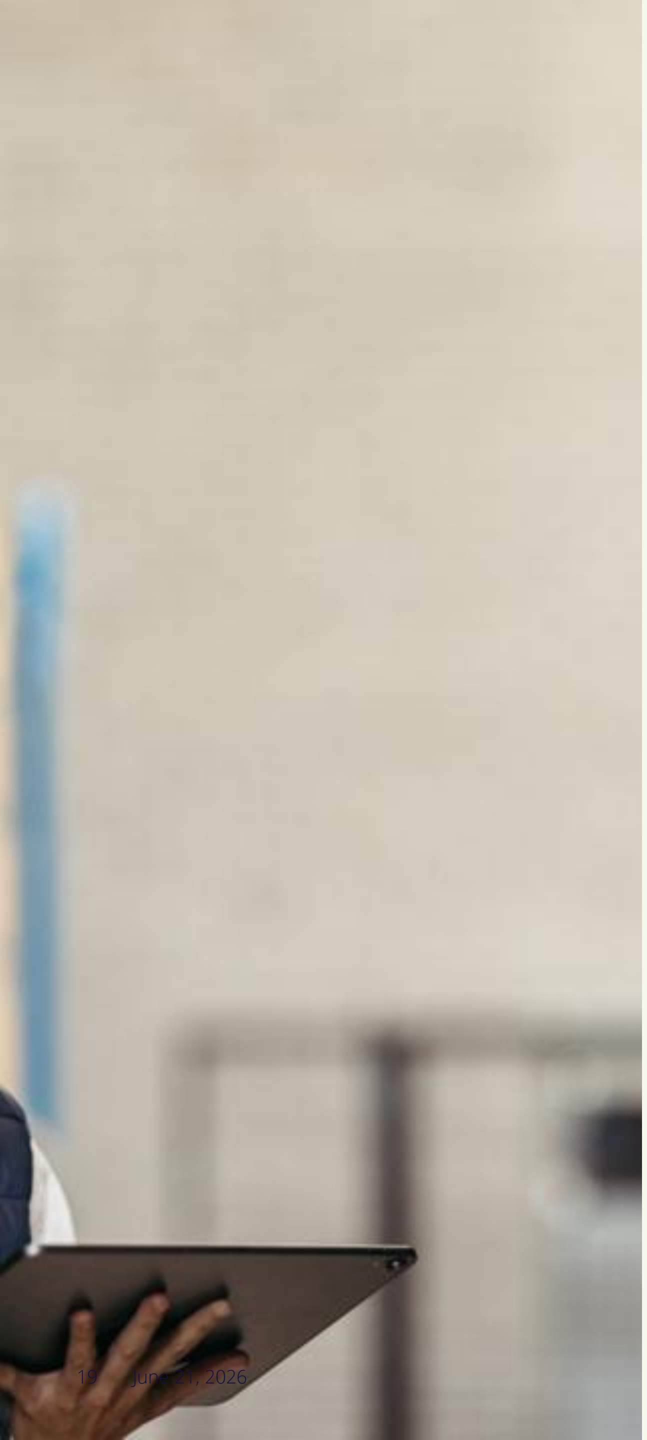
Standard Class leads profit at 164,088.79. Second Class follows at 57,446.64. This suggests slower modes preserve margin and support better profit quality.

02 Expedite with discipline

First Class contributes 48,969.84. Same Day adds 15,891.76. Use faster service where urgency or customer value offsets the margin trade-off.

Takeaway: Standard Class is the strongest operating lever

Profit quality improves when demand shifts toward Standard Class. Expedited options should stay targeted to protect margin and service economics.



Order quality signals operational levers

Order size and postal-code quality show improvement opportunities.

Order mix pattern

- Most orders contain 1 to 4 items
- Sales cluster below 100 dollars
- Few orders exceed 5K

Many small orders can raise handling costs. Basket-building can improve unit economics.

01

Data quality signal

- Postal code tracked as complete
- Postal code tracked as missing
- Address quality affects fulfillment

Completeness tracking reveals address quality gaps. Better data can cut service costs.

02

Margin leakage is broad

Low profit and loss making orders are widespread

Weak profit is widely dispersed

The profit distribution shows many loss making records alongside a long tail of low profit orders. This signals recurring leakage across numerous transactions rather than an isolated exception that can be fixed once.

Small orders amplify the issue

Sales are concentrated in many orders under $100. That pattern means low profit conditions can repeat at scale, so leadership needs controls that work across everyday transactions, not only major deals.

Strategic solutions

01

Tighten margin guardrails

Set clear floors, alerts, and approval rules for transactions most likely to dilute profit.

02

Standardize discount discipline

Use category rules and exception reviews to limit repeat leakage in loss prone order patterns.

03

Focus on repeat drivers

Target the recurring conditions that repeatedly create low profit orders across the portfolio.

Discount discipline is the clearest profit lever

Average discount is 8.57%, discounts reach 100%, and zero discount is linked to materially higher profit

01 Discount profile

Average discount is 8.57%, with some transactions discounted up to 100%. This shows margin is routinely given away, not only in rare exceptions.

02 Influencer finding

Key influencer analysis shows profit is more likely to increase when discount is 0, with average profit up 129.2. Discounting is materially shaping outcomes.

Management action: enforce tighter thresholds, category rules, and exception monitoring

The clearest near term move is stricter discount governance in loss prone sub categories, backed by approval thresholds and active exception review.

Predictive drivers reveal risk pockets

Recurring category, sub category, and quantity patterns can trigger earlier pricing and sales intervention

Category risk

Office Supplies patterns are more likely to be associated with weaker profit outcomes. That makes the category a priority for pricing review and tighter governance.

Sub category risk

Art, Fasteners, Supplies, Labels, and Furnishings are linked to lower profit likelihood. These pockets need sharper pricing, bundle design, and exception control.

Low quantity risk

Orders of 1 item or 1 to 2 items also correlate with weak profit. Small baskets need proactive intervention before low margin deals close.

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Move from reactive review to proactive intervention

These recurring patterns can be used as early warning signals. Management can target pricing, bundling, governance, and frontline intervention before weak profit orders accumulate.

Revenue quality drill-down

Trace sales to the pockets that create value

Start with total and segment mix

Begin with total sales of about 2.297M. Consumer contributes 1.161M, making it the largest segment and the first place to test whether scale also carries healthy economics.

Break segment into categories

Within Consumer, category mix is Technology 406K, Furniture 391K, and Office Supplies 364K. That isolates the largest category before drilling further into what drives it.

Go deeper to sub-category and region

Within Technology, Phones lead at 169.9K, followed by Accessories at 87.1K and Machines at 79.5K. Within Phones, East leads at 51.5K and West at 50.5K.

From growth to profitable growth

The issue is not growth vs. profit, but undisciplined vs. value-led growth

01	**Current state**	Revenue is growing across categories and strong cities. But profit leaks through weak sub-categories, heavy discounting, low-value orders, and costly fast shipping.
02	**Desired state**	Growth is led by high-contribution categories, sharper segment and city focus, disciplined discounting, and operating choices that support margin quality.
03	**Management shift**	The business can now move beyond descriptive reporting to a management model that rewards profitable growth, not undisciplined volume.

Six levers to improve growth quality

Target margin leakage, scale profitable demand, and build tighter commercial control

Pricing governance

1

- Curb discount-driven value loss. Protect margin and core demand.
- Set discount guardrails. Approve exceptions with proof.

Mix optimization

2

- Shift away from loss-making lines. Back healthier categories.
- Reduce Tables and Machines. Prioritize stronger sub-categories.

Segment plays

3

- Scale where economics are strongest. Tailor offers by segment need.
- Replicate Home Office wins. Refine segment playbooks.

City and account focus

4

- Target demand clusters. Grow anchor market share.
- Build top-city plans. Deepen key account coverage.

Fulfillment discipline

5

- Cut weak ship-mode drag. Align service and profit.
- Favor Standard Class. Tighten shipping approvals.

Data and monitoring

6

- Improve signals for faster action. Track sales and margin.
- Fix data gaps. Launch margin quality dashboards.

Balance quick wins and structural fixes

Act first on margin leakage, then scale proven demand patterns and stronger operating control

Recommendation matrix

Prioritize actions in three waves. First, impose discount controls and reduce exposure to loss-making sub-categories because they offer the fastest profit lift. Next, replicate stronger segment and city patterns, especially where Home Office economics and top-city demand are most attractive. In parallel, tighten shipping governance and raise order value so margin gains endure while revenue remains protected.

01

Evidence

- → Zero discount lifts profit
- → Tables and Machines lose
- → Home Office most profitable
- → Standard Class wins

02

Validation logic

Test each action against contribution quality, not sales alone. Confirm that discount guardrails reduce margin erosion without stalling volume. Track whether mix shifts away from weak categories improve profit per order. Validate regional and account plays by growth in top cities. Monitor shipping mix, average order value, and dashboard data quality to sustain results.

Execution roadmap from stabilization to scale

Sequence near-term margin repair, mix improvements, growth activation, and governance routines

01

Stabilize margin

Set discount guardrails. Stop loss-making category exposure. Create weekly issue review.

02

Optimize mix

Build product playbooks. Scale profitable segments. Raise order value quality.

03

Activate markets

Target top cities and regions. Deepen key account plans. Replicate local winning patterns.

04

Institutionalize

Launch margin dashboards. Embed governance cadences. Review sales with profit quality.

From growth to better earnings

Sales momentum is clear. Next is improving profit quality and control.

What the analysis says

Growth is real and diversified, but earnings quality is under pressure. Discounting, loss-making sub-categories, uneven regional economics, and lower-value orders are limiting conversion from sales into clean profit growth.

Immediate management agenda

01

Tighten pricing

Reduce unnecessary discounting. Protect price realization. Rebuild margin discipline.

02

Rebalance the mix

Shift toward stronger categories. Exit weak sub-categories. Back higher-value demand.

03

Focus where profit wins

Prioritize profitable customers and cities. Align shipping choices with order value. Improve planning confidence.

Thank you!